

# Performance Management Policy

|           |                               |                |                                    |
|-----------|-------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| Policy ID | HR-PERF-201                   | Owner          | People Operations                  |
| Effective | January 1, 2026               | Next review    | January 1, 2027                    |
| Status    | Current                       | Classification | Internal                           |
| Audience  | Employees and people managers | Company        | Northstar Technologies (fictional) |

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

## 1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes goal setting, regular feedback, quarterly check-ins, annual reviews, calibration, recognition, and formal performance improvement. Performance discussions should be timely, specific, job-related, and documented appropriately.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

## 2. Summary of Key Rules

| Activity         | Frequency          | Primary owner        | Record             |
|------------------|--------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Goal review      | At least quarterly | Employee and manager | Performance system |
| One-on-one       | Normally biweekly  | Manager              | Working notes      |
| Annual review    | Once per year      | Manager              | Performance system |
| Improvement plan | As needed          | Manager and HR       | Formal plan        |

## 3. Goals and Feedback

Goals should describe expected outcomes, measures, dependencies, and timing. They may be revised when priorities change. Feedback should identify observable behavior and business impact, and should be provided close to the event. Employees are expected to raise blockers and ask for clarification rather than waiting for a formal review.

## 4. Quarterly and Annual Reviews

Quarterly check-ins address progress, workload, development, and changed priorities. The annual review considers results and behaviors across the full period, not only recent events. Calibration supports consistency but does not require identical ratings across teams. A performance rating does not guarantee a compensation change.

## 5. Performance Improvement

When expectations are not met, the manager should explain the gap, expected improvement, support, and review timing. A formal performance improvement plan normally lasts 30 to 90 days, depending on the issue. Serious misconduct or urgent risk may require different action. Placement on a plan may affect eligibility for recurring remote work.

## 6. Review and Employee Response

Employees may add written comments to a formal review and may raise process concerns with the manager's manager or People Operations. Disagreement alone does not remove a review from the record. Retaliation for a good-faith complaint is prohibited. Medical or other protected information should be handled through the appropriate accommodation or leave process.

## 7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Compensation and Salary Changes Policy; Remote and Hybrid Work Policy; Workplace Conduct and Reporting Policy.

## Version history

| Version | Effective date  | Change                                              |
|---------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1.0     | January 1, 2026 | Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation. |